Mechanism-Disagreement-Driven Active Evidence Selection and Set Calibration for Compositional Multi-Agent Social Simulation

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Abstract

Matching historical participation totals does not identify the mechanisms that produced them. Broad information exposure with low participation propensity and narrow exposure with high propensity can fit the same aggregate history, yet respond differently when waiting lists, peer forwarding, and schedule conflicts interact. We study budgeted process-evidence acquisition for this setting using a finite set of historically compatible simulators. Shared stage parameters are screened against process and trajectory observations, then weighted by a noise-normalized worst-event discrepancy. Cached compositional probes turn expected predictive variance reduction into a weighted-covariance calculation; small batches integrate hypothetical outcomes without simulator reruns. In V1, an auditable 60-candidate development search reduces normalized trajectory-error AUC by 78.94%, with frozen synthetic test AUC 0.006916. Covariance scoring is 217.95× faster than the supplied explicit enumeration implementation in paired GPU microbenchmarks. However, evaluation over 24 independent synthetic worlds reveals an important limitation: the selected calibration distribution has effective size 1.000385, and matched-prior acquisition, matched single-point estimation, and two acquisition ablations perform almost identically. Unknown-rule diagnostics also miss weaker shifts. These results establish an efficient, reproducible formulation while showing that aggregate predictive improvement can suppress the very mechanism disagreement needed for active evidence selection. A separate 30-configuration extension retains a noncollapsed prior and restores matched-prior acquisition gains on a constructed interaction stress test, while tying parameter information gain. The study is synthetic; it does not establish real-data performance, official benchmark rankings, or general submodular guarantees.

1 Introduction

Suppose two simulations predict the same number of people attending an activity. In one, almost everyone receives the announcement but few are interested. In the other, few people receive it, but most recipients want to participate. A historical attendance count cannot by itself distinguish these explanations. Their difference becomes consequential when a new activity combines forwarding, a waiting list, and overlapping schedules: forwarding changes who knows about the opportunity, waiting-list turnover changes who can obtain a place, and conflicts determine which intentions become attendance. The example applies to resource allocation and collective participation more generally; a campus is an executable instance, not the intended boundary of the research question.

Calibration from aggregate outputs is therefore an inverse problem with potentially non-identifiable mechanisms. Set-based approaches already recognize that multiple parameters can be statistically eligible (Bai et al., 2022). The remaining operational question is which additional process observation is useful when collecting every micro-level record is unnecessary or costly. A record can have high behavioral entropy yet reveal little about a future quantity of interest. Conversely, a modest disagreement about viewing an announcement may be valuable if it separates mechanisms that imply different future congestion trajectories. Goal-oriented experimental design provides the appropriate perspective: the value of evidence depends on the prediction it is meant to improve (Chaloner and Verdinelli, 1995; Attia et al., 2018; Zhong et al., 2026).

We instantiate this perspective with a finite mechanism bank, explicit environmental settlement, and cached training-rule combination probes. A shared parameter vector controls attention, participation, and waiting-list dropout. Separate process and trajectory checks form a compatible set. A trajectory-based weighting rule then defines a calibrated mixture, and a weighted covariance ranks binary process records by their expected reduction of probe disagreement per unit cost. The same cache supports posterior updates and a distribution over complete paths, so no model retraining or simulator rerun is required inside a query step.

The experimental outcome is more qualified than this construction might suggest. Development selection strongly favors concentrated trajectory weights. The best predictor consequently retains many candidates in its hard set but almost no effective mixture diversity. Its trajectory score improves while its individual-process Brier score worsens. Acquisition ablations have little visible effect because there is little remaining disagreement to resolve. This is not a peripheral failure: it exposes a tension between optimizing aggregate predictive accuracy and preserving useful uncertainty for subsequent evidence acquisition.

Our contributions are threefold. First, we give an explicit, reproducible formulation of process-constrained set calibration and budgeted evidence selection for a multi-agent simulator that separates behavioral intentions from realized outcomes. Second, we implement the binary predictive-variance identity as a batched covariance operation, integrate hypothetical labels for small batches, and state its computational and statistical assumptions. We do not claim the identity or goal-oriented design principle as new. Third, we provide an audited synthetic study separating calibration gains from acquisition gains, including matched-prior controls, activity-level uncertainty, and unknown-rule stress tests. The resulting evidence identifies posterior concentration as a practical failure mode and limits claims that could otherwise be drawn from favorable aggregate scores.

The work should be read as a methodological and diagnostic study. It provides neither a demonstrated state-of-the-art result on SocioVerse nor a result on a MIT real-behavior benchmark. An interface with the required field names does not constitute an evaluated dataset. This distinction also determines the paper's scope: the general formulation is portable, whereas the empirical conclusions concern the constructed system studied here.

2 Problem setup

Partially observed social dynamics. Let $i \in \{1, \dots, N\}$ index agents and e index activities. At time t, the global state is $s_t = (h_{1t}, \dots, h_{Nt}, g_t)$, where h_{it} contains interest, availability, remaining budget, received information, and participation experience. The environment state g_t contains notifications, application windows, capacities, bookings, waiting lists, and schedules. Agent i observes $o_{it} \sim O_i(\cdot \mid s_t)$ and forms an intention $u_{it} \sim \pi_\theta(\cdot \mid o_{it}, h_{it})$. Interactions produce messages $m_t \sim G_\theta(\cdot \mid s_t, u_t)$. Settlement maps intentions and messages to realized outcomes, followed by state feedback:

$$a_t \sim K_\xi(\cdot \mid s_t, u_t, m_t), \qquad s_{t+1} \sim F_\xi(\cdot \mid s_t, a_t, m_t). \tag{1}$$

Here ξ denotes environmental rules. Equation (1) is a partially observed multi-agent stochastic system; no reward optimization or policy-learning claim is required. A wish to register is not a booking: capacity, time conflicts, and budget may reject it, while cancellation and replacement may change later realized participation.

The implementation uses $\theta = (a, b, d)$ for attention, conditional participation, and waiting dropout, shared across activities. Heterogeneous agent states and activity features still produce different individual probabilities. A single agent population participates in interacting activities within each simulated world. The population trajectory X_{etc} records fractions registered, waiting, and attending, with channel $c \in \{1, 2, 3\}$. For candidate m and simulation seed s, the cached path is X_{msetc}. Each path uses one fixed mechanism throughout; averaging parameters or switching mechanisms between time steps would define a different simulator.

Historical information and evidence opportunities. The historical data comprise observed trajectories and a separate audit cohort with binary stage records. An acquisition pool contains additional audit people, each contributing one record at a standardized, known opportunity state. Its candidate probability is $p_{mr} = P(Y_r = 1 \mid \theta_m, x_r)$ and its acquisition cost is $k_r > 0$. In the supplied benchmark, records are conditionally independent given a mechanism, and availability metadata are known before acquisition. We do not infer independence for arbitrary logs from an interacting population. Reusing a process total as independent evidence after observing its constituent records would double-count information; the disjoint cohorts avoid that specific dependency.

Compositional prediction objective. Write an activity configuration as $\xi = (\ell, f, c, \eta)$, with waiting-list, forwarding, and conflict indicators (ℓ, f, c) and remaining event attributes η. Historical activities expose waiting and forwarding separately; the conflict rule is available in the simulator but inactive in all historical configurations. Fixed probes combine these accessible rules to approximate future prediction demands. An acquisition policy α selects a sequence Q with $\sum_{r \in Q} k_r \leq B$ and updates a mixture over mechanisms. Its scientific objective is low trajectory risk under a target activity distribution:

$$\mathcal{R}_B(\alpha) = \mathbb{E}_{\xi, Y, Q \sim \alpha}\Big[L\big(\widehat{X}(\xi \mid Y_Q), X^{\text{true}}(\xi)\big)\Big]. \tag{2}$$

Probe disagreement is a computable, model-internal surrogate for this risk, not an estimator guaranteed to be unbiased for it. The cache includes train, probe, development, and test banks. Development already includes pairwise and triple combinations; test uses distinct event instantiations, not rule combinations unseen throughout all development. We therefore describe the experiment as transfer beyond the empirical training activities, rather than unrestricted compositional out-of-distribution generalization. Introducing a rule absent from every candidate is a separate misspecification experiment.

3 Methodology

The following equations describe the frozen V1 implementation. The separately preregistered V2 extension is given in Section 4.5. In particular, the final evolution changes the calibration distance, not the covariance acquisition formula. Unused alternative losses remaining in the source are not components of the reported method.

3.1 Compatible mechanisms and calibrated weights

Let $\bar{X}_{metc} = S^{-1} \sum_s X_{msetc}$ and let H_{etc} be the observed historical trajectory mean. For the observed history records $\mathcal{O}$, define separate process and trajectory discrepancies

$$\begin{aligned} B_m &= |\mathcal{O}|^{-1} \sum_{r \in \mathcal{O}} (p_{mr} - y_r)^2, \\ R_m &= \left[(ETC)^{-1} \sum_{etc} (\bar{X}_{metc} - H_{etc})^2 \right]^{1/2}. \end{aligned} \tag{3}$$

When $\mathcal{O}$ is empty, $B_m = 0$. The compatible set is

$$\mathcal{C} = \{m : B_m \leq \min_j B_j + 0.045\} \cap \{m : R_m \leq 0.10\}. \tag{4}$$

An empty set raises an error instead of silently widening tolerances. These empirical gates provide neither confidence-set coverage nor a guarantee that the true mechanism is on the grid. In particular, process Brier discrepancy is a screening statistic, not a Bernoulli log likelihood.

The final calibration rule normalizes trajectory residuals by estimated simulation noise and emphasizes the worst historical event:

$$v_{etc} = \frac{1}{MS}\sum_{m,s}(X_{msetc} - \bar{X}_{metc})^2, \qquad \bar{v} = \frac{1}{ETC}\sum_{etc} v_{etc},$$

$$r_{etc} = \frac{v_{etc}+\epsilon}{\bar{v}+\epsilon}, \qquad D_m = \max_e \frac{1}{TC}\sum_{tc}\frac{(\bar{X}_{metc} - H_{etc})^2}{r_{etc}}, \tag{5}$$

$$w_m^{(0)} = \frac{\mathbf{1}\{m \in \mathcal{C}\}\exp[-D_m/(2\sigma^2)]}{\sum_{j\in\mathcal{C}}\exp[-D_j/(2\sigma^2)]}, \qquad \epsilon = 10^{-5}, \quad \sigma = 7\times 10^{-4}. \tag{6}$$

Variance is computed with divisor S and averaged over all M candidates before screening. It is seed variance, not variance of the Monte Carlo mean. This supplies time- and channel-dependent precision weights through r_{etc}; there is no separately learned temporal attention term or higher-order acquisition correction. The resulting distribution is a Gibbs calibration mixture. Calling it an exact posterior for the historical trajectory-generating process would require an observation likelihood that the implementation does not specify.

3.2 Missing viewing records and observation likelihoods

In the standardized audit cohort, unobserved viewing is integrated out. If V_r indicates viewing and I_r an intention, then

$$P(I_r = 1 \mid \theta_m) = P(V_r = 1 \mid \theta_m)P(I_r = 1 \mid V_r = 1, \theta_m) = a_m \rho_{e(r)} b_m \iota_r, \tag{7}$$

where ρ_e is notification reach and ι_r is recorded interest. Thus a missing view is not a negative view. Waiting-dropout records condition on a known waiting-risk state. These formulas are not substitutes for filtering an unobserved interaction history.

For a revealed record with observation indicator o_r, the supplied MCAR benchmark uses $\ell_{mr} = p_{mr}^{y_r}(1-p_{mr})^{1-y_r}$ when $o_r = 1$ and $\ell_{mr} = 1$ otherwise. The optional known observation model $\gamma_{mry} = P(o_r = 1 \mid Y_r = y, \theta_m)$ instead gives

$$\ell_{mr} = \begin{cases} p_{mr}^{y_r}(1-p_{mr})^{1-y_r}\gamma_{mry_r}, & o_r = 1, \\ (1-p_{mr})(1-\gamma_{mr0}) + p_{mr}(1-\gamma_{mr1}), & o_r = 0. \end{cases} \tag{8}$$

This distinction follows the need to model nonignorable observation processes (Rubin, 1976). The optional branch is unit-tested, not empirically validated under real missingness. Right-censoring is different: a pending time-to-event observation would require a survival likelihood such as $P(T_r > t_{\text{cut}} \mid \theta_m)$ and a specified event-time model. That extension is not implemented; our evidence pool consists of completed binary opportunities.

3.3 Cached probes and the covariance acquisition identity

Let $z_m \in \mathbb{R}^D$ concatenate the candidate's mean trajectories on the fixed combination probes, with $D = E_{\text{p}}TC$. Given current weights w, define

$$\mu = \sum_m w_m z_m, \qquad q_r = \sum_m w_m p_{mr}, \qquad c_r = \sum_m w_m(p_{mr} - q_r)(z_m - \mu). \tag{9}$$

The acquisition value is

$$A_r(w) = \frac{\|c_r\|_2^2}{Dk_r q_r(1-q_r)}, \qquad C = P^\top \operatorname{diag}(w)(Z - \mathbf{1}\mu^\top). \tag{10}$$

Rows of C contain all $c_r^\top$. Computing the matrix product shares work across records. The denominator is clamped below by 10^{-12} in code; deterministic observations have zero exact value.

Proposition 1 (Binary predictive-variance reduction)**.** *For fixed cached conditional means $Z = z_\theta$, the model-implied binary observation law, and $0 < q_r < 1$, the expected reduction in mean coordinate variance after observing Y_r equals $k_r A_r(w)$.*

Proof. Let $\mu_y = \mathbb{E}[Z \mid Y_r = y]$. Bayes' rule yields $\mu_1 - \mu = c_r/q_r$ and $\mu_0 - \mu = -c_r/(1-q_r)$. Applying total covariance gives

$$\begin{aligned}\frac{1}{D}\operatorname{tr}\{\operatorname{Cov}(Z) - \mathbb{E}_{Y_r}\operatorname{Cov}(Z \mid Y_r)\} &= \frac{q_r\|\mu_1-\mu\|^2 + (1-q_r)\|\mu_0-\mu\|^2}{D} \\ &= \frac{\|c_r\|^2}{Dq_r(1-q_r)}. \end{aligned} \tag{11}$$

□

This is a specialization of predictive variance reduction, not a new general optimal-design theorem. Its role is to justify an efficient implementation. It requires that the observation change the target only through mechanism weights. If obtaining a record intervenes on an agent or reveals a target-correlated latent state not represented by θ, the conditional trajectories must also change; the cached formula alone is then insufficient. Nor does internal expected variance reduction imply a reduction in realized RMSE, aleatoric variance, or model discrepancy.

3.4 Small-batch conditioning and predictive uncertainty

To avoid evaluating every member of a batch under the same unupdated weights, maintain hypothetical branches $\mathcal{F}_j = \{(\pi_f, w_f)\}$ after j selections. The next record maximizes

$$r_{j+1} = \operatorname*{arg\,max}_{r \text{ eligible}} \sum_{f \in \mathcal{F}_j} \pi_f A_r(w_f). \tag{12}$$

Each branch splits under $y \in \{0,1\}$ using $L_{mry} = p_{mr}^y(1-p_{mr})^{1-y}$, branch probability $q_{fy} = \sum_m w_{fm}L_{mry}$, mass $\pi_f q_{fy}$, and weights $w_{fm}L_{mry}/q_{fy}$. Selection reads no realized labels. This exactly averages hypothetical outcomes for a greedy batch under conditional independence, while branches of probability at most 10^{-12} are omitted numerically. It is neither globally optimal batch search nor a generally submodular objective; Section 5.2 gives a counterexample. Batch size is two, with an implementation limit of four.

After acquisition, the actual evidence updates weights according to

$$w'_m \propto w_m \exp\left\{\tau^{-1}\sum_{r\in Q}\log \ell_{mr}\right\}, \qquad \tau = 1. \tag{13}$$

Logarithm inputs are clipped to $[10^{-7}, 1-10^{-7}]$; zero prior mass remains zero. The target distribution is a mixture of complete cached paths,

$$\widehat{P}(X^* \mid Y_Q) = \sum_{m,s}\frac{w'_m}{S}\delta_{X^*_{ms}}, \qquad \widehat{\mu} = \sum_m w'_m \bar{X}^*_m. \tag{14}$$

Its coordinatewise uncertainty decomposes as

$$\begin{aligned} V_{\text{epi}} &= \sum_m w'_m(\bar{X}^*_m - \widehat{\mu})^2, \\ V_{\text{alea}} &= \sum_m w'_m \frac{1}{S}\sum_s (X^*_{ms} - \bar{X}^*_m)^2. \end{aligned} \tag{15}$$

Weighted fifth and ninety-fifth percentiles give pointwise 90% predictive intervals. They are not simultaneous path bands or confidence intervals for the real population. Complete atoms preserve temporal dependence even when marginal plots do not display it.

Algorithm 1 Compatible-mechanism inference with cached process evidence

Require: Historical data; caches X, P, Z, X^*; eligible pool U; costs k; budget B
Compute B_m, R_m and $\mathcal{C}$ by Eqs. (3)–(4)
if $\mathcal{C} = \emptyset$ **then**
    raise model-inadequacy error
end if
Compute v, r, D; initialize w by Eqs. (5)–(6)
while an affordable record remains in U **do**
    $\mathcal{F} \leftarrow \{(1, w)\}$, $Q \leftarrow \emptyset$, $B_{\text{reserve}} \leftarrow B$
    for $j = 1, 2$ **do**
        $U' \leftarrow \{r \in U \setminus Q : k_r \le B_{\text{reserve}}\}$
        if $U' = \emptyset$ **then**
            break
        end if
        Score all $r \in U'$ using Eqs. (10) and (12)
        Select maximum-score r; add to Q; reserve k_r
        Expand each branch for both binary outcomes of r
    end for
    Retrieve Y_Q and observation mask; compute Eq. (8)
    Update w by Eq. (13); $U \leftarrow U \setminus Q$, $B \leftarrow B - \sum_{r \in Q} k_r$
end while
return whole-path mixture, mean, V_{epi}, V_{alea}, marginal quantiles

Computational cost. Given M mechanisms, R records and D probe coordinates, cached probabilities and conditional means require $O(MR + MD)$ memory. Full seed trajectories add $O(MSD)$ storage per bank. A covariance pass costs $O(MRD)$ arithmetic; explicit binary-outcome enumeration has the same order, but repeats centering and reductions in many small operations. The measured advantage is vectorization and shared computation, not a lower asymptotic complexity. Exact branch averaging for batch size b costs $O((2^b - 1)MRD)$ in the worst case, explaining the small-batch restriction. A label update costs $O(Mb)$, while target means and variances cost $O(MSD_*)$ and marginal sorting adds $O(D_* MS \log(MS))$. Offline simulation cost is paid before these operations. The mathematical interface is domain-independent, but both observation probabilities and the simulator bank remain domain-specific.

4 Experiments

4.1 Protocol, baselines, and inferential units

Constructed benchmark. The resource-participation simulator contains 128 agents, eight time steps, and three trajectory channels. Its mechanism bank has 200 candidates: ten attention values, ten participation values, and two dropout values. Eight seeds represent each candidate. Four historical activities and four accessible-rule probes support calibration and acquisition; development and test each contain three interacting activities. Waiting and forwarding occur separately in history, but conflicts are activated only in probes and later splits. Thus not every rule component has empirical training coverage. The true parameter is $(0.90, 0.30, 0.27)$, so its dropout coordinate is not exactly represented in the two-level candidate grid. Historical audits contain 96 intent records with 20% missingness; the acquisition pool contains 160 records with 15% missingness, generated MCAR. All costs are one record. Candidate paths share simulation random numbers; truth uses separate seeds. The internal name `SocioVerse_Campus` denotes this constructed benchmark, not official SocioVerse data.

Frozen selection and evaluation. An automated research controller proposed and evaluated 60 distinct modifications of the sole algorithm file. Ten were retained and 50 reverted, with every hypothesis and source version archived. The fixed evaluator, budget grid $\{0, 2, 4, 8, 12, 16\}$, and

cache were not optimized during this loop. The best method was frozen before the first reported test evaluation. Later reruns verify reproduction and are not new holdouts. The original metric is normalized trapezoidal AUC of pooled trajectory RMSE:

$$A_{\text{pool}} = \frac{1}{16}\sum_{j=1}^{J}(b_j - b_{j-1})\frac{R_{\text{pool}}(b_j) + R_{\text{pool}}(b_{j-1})}{2}. \tag{16}$$

Trajectory errors use population fractions. The original three events share people, budget and conflicts, so their time points cannot be treated as independent samples.

To quantify variability, a post-freeze supplemental protocol generated 24 independent worlds with population and rollout variation while fixing training observations, acquisition evidence, and three activity templates. For each template we compute A_e by replacing pooled RMSE in Eq. (16) with within-event RMSE, and define $A_{\text{macro}} = \frac{1}{3}\sum_e A_e$. Whole-world bootstrap resampling (2,000 draws, fixed seed) preserves dependence between activities. Random-query repetitions are averaged inside each world. Tables report each template's 24 independent realizations and conditional 95% intervals; they do not represent 72 unrelated activities, new training datasets, or new domains. The supplement was specified after the original test had been inspected and is reported as a post-freeze extension, not a prospectively untouched second benchmark.

Comparison policies. Random selects available records uniformly. Entropy maximizes binary predictive entropy per cost. ParamIG uses $h(q_r) - \sum_m w_m h(p_{mr})$, where h is binary entropy. Standard OED uses predictive variance reduction directed at historical trajectories rather than combination probes; it represents this specific goal choice, not all goal-oriented design. The original policies begin from uniform compatible weights, while Full begins from Eq. (6). We therefore add matched-prior versions to isolate acquisition. Passive baselines include a simple historical-mean model, an uncalibrated mixture, process-only and trajectory-only calibration, and passive V1 joint calibration. These are synthetic statistical baselines, not substitutes for unexecuted original-product or LLM baselines.

4.2 RQ1: Does a compatible set preserve useful mechanism uncertainty?

The final hard set contains 170 candidates, but only 12 have nonzero float32 weights, and only two exceed 10^{-4}. The initial effective size $(\sum_m w_m^2)^{-1}$ is 1.000385, with largest weight 0.999808. The most heavily weighted mechanism is approximately $(0.4167, 0.6833, 0.42)$, markedly different from the generating attention and participation values. Low trajectory error thus does not establish mechanism recovery.

An additional ambiguity check selects a candidate pair using history and probes, without test outcomes. Its historical pairwise trajectory RMSE is 0.011732, and its probe RMSE is 0.011481. The pair has different parameters, but this observed pair does *not* demonstrate a dramatic amplification of disagreement on combinations. The motivating ambiguity remains a scientifically plausible problem; this diagnostic alone is insufficient to claim that the benchmark realizes its strongest form.

The original single-point baseline uses a different point-selection loss from Full. A matched MAP control instead places all mass on the largest-weight candidate under the evolved calibration. Table 1 shows that Full's macro AUC is 0.007064, compared with 0.007065 for matched MAP. This difference is negligible on the population-fraction scale. Table 12 provides paired activity differences rather than inferring significance from overlap of marginal intervals. The results do not establish that preserving the mixture improves accuracy materially.

Unknown-rule diagnostics. We separately introduce unmodeled waiting dropout, two-hop peer propagation, their combination, and a strong transport cancellation shock. Candidate rules remain frozen. The interval diagnostic triggers after observing an activity if more than 20% of its cells lie outside the pointwise 90% predictive interval. Table 2 and Figure 1 distinguish false alarms from detection. False-alarm rates vary substantially across activities, and waiting/propagation detection

Table 1: Macro AUC $\times 10^3$ and descriptive mean differences. Intervals are world-bootstrap intervals on the mean, not predictive intervals.

Method	Macro AUC	Difference from Full
Full	7.0635 [6.0247, 8.0995]	+0.0000
Matched MAP	7.0655 [6.0267, 8.1012]	+0.0019
Matched-prior Random	7.0589 [6.0192, 8.0962]	-0.0046
Without combination target	7.0635 [6.0247, 8.0995]	+0.0000
Without batch conditioning	7.0635 [6.0247, 8.0995]	+0.0000
Without sharing*	39.8238 [38.5402, 41.0323]	+32.7602

Table 2: Post-observation interval alarm rates (percent) and 95% world-bootstrap intervals for Full. The none row measures false alarms. Endpoint bootstrap intervals can degenerate with 24 worlds.

Truth rule	Activity 1	Activity 2	Activity 3
none	4.2 [0.0, 12.5]	25.0 [8.3, 41.7]	8.3 [0.0, 20.8]
waiting	12.5 [0.0, 25.0]	20.8 [4.2, 37.5]	8.3 [0.0, 20.8]
propagation	8.3 [0.0, 20.8]	16.7 [4.2, 33.3]	16.7 [4.2, 33.3]
both	12.5 [0.0, 25.0]	12.5 [0.0, 25.0]	16.7 [4.2, 33.3]
transport	100.0 [100.0, 100.0]	100.0 [100.0, 100.0]	100.0 [100.0, 100.0]

is weak. The strong transport shift is detected in all 24 worlds for every template. Endpoint bootstrap intervals can then collapse; a sample rate of one does not imply perfect population sensitivity. The original evaluator's diagnostic requires both low epistemic variance and RMSE above 0.08. It never triggers for the waiting and propagation perturbations in this supplement. Table 14 reports actual truth displacement: the waiting perturbation is small in some templates, so non-detection is not evidence of equal failure severity across shifts. Both diagnostics use realized outcomes and are not advance warnings. Shared agreement among misspecified candidates cannot, by itself, identify a missing rule.

4.3 RQ2: What improves evidence efficiency, and what is accelerated?

The original development AUC decreases from 0.025791 to 0.005432, a 78.94% reduction after adaptive selection on the same development set. The frozen test AUC is 0.006916. This is evidence for the selected predictor on the fixed synthetic evaluation, not a percentage improvement over an external state of the art. The independent-world macro result is a different statistic and must not be substituted for the pooled test score.

Table 3 and the top row of Figure 2 show the original comparison. The lower Full curve includes the benefit of evolved calibration, whereas the other selectors start from uniform compatible weights. Under the matched-prior comparison in Table 4, the apparent acquisition advantage disappears. Matched-prior Random has macro AUC 0.007059, slightly below Full's 0.007064. The differences are very small, and the near-flat curves indicate that the initially concentrated weights largely determine prediction. These controls prevent attributing calibration gains to the query criterion.

Scoring microbenchmark. We compare covariance scoring with explicit enumeration of both binary outcomes, using identical candidates, cached predictions, probabilities, and costs. Ten GPU-synchronized timing pairs alternate execution order. Table 5 reports median per-pair speedups of

Table 3: Original comparison: calibration and acquisition both vary. Activity AUC $\times 10^3$ with 95% world-bootstrap intervals; 24 worlds, fixed training data, evidence and templates.

Method	Activity 1	Activity 2	Activity 3
Random	17.82 [17.23, 18.39]	19.03 [18.10, 20.01]	14.96 [14.46, 15.44]
Entropy	12.94 [12.27, 13.64]	10.15 [9.21, 11.16]	8.19 [7.32, 9.14]
ParamIG	12.98 [12.34, 13.68]	10.80 [10.06, 11.59]	8.56 [7.50, 9.73]
Standard OED	23.59 [22.32, 24.75]	27.44 [24.79, 30.05]	21.58 [19.34, 23.61]
Full	4.19 [3.38, 5.07]	10.85 [8.78, 12.85]	6.15 [3.98, 8.65]

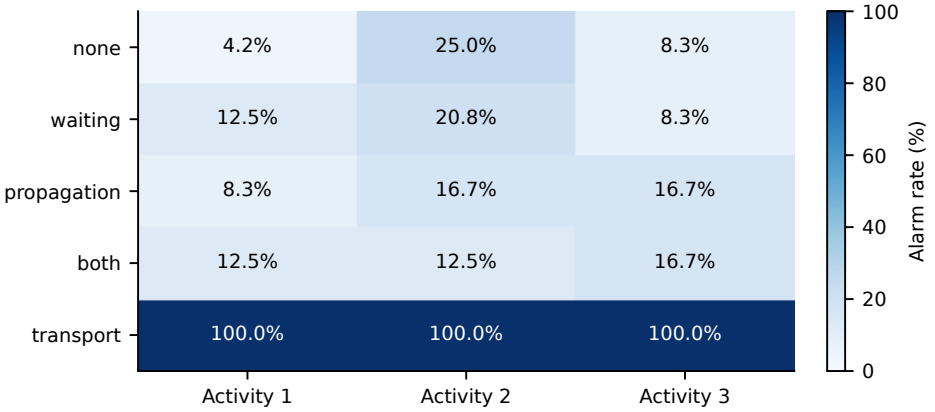


Figure 1: Full-model post-observation alarm rates on synthetic worlds. The no-shift row is a false-alarm control. Good detection of a large cancellation shock coexists with weak detection of waiting and propagation shifts. Intervals appear in Table 2.

Table 4: Controlled acquisition comparison: all methods use the evolved prior. Activity AUC $\times 10^3$ with 95% world-bootstrap intervals; 24 worlds, fixed training data, evidence and templates.

Method	Activity 1	Activity 2	Activity 3
Matched-prior Random	4.19 [3.38, 5.07]	10.84 [8.77, 12.84]	6.15 [3.98, 8.65]
Matched-prior Entropy	4.19 [3.38, 5.07]	10.85 [8.78, 12.85]	6.15 [3.98, 8.65]
Matched-prior ParamIG	4.19 [3.38, 5.07]	10.85 [8.78, 12.85]	6.15 [3.98, 8.65]
Matched-prior Standard OED	4.19 [3.38, 5.07]	10.85 [8.78, 12.85]	6.15 [3.98, 8.65]
Full	4.19 [3.38, 5.07]	10.85 [8.78, 12.85]	6.15 [3.98, 8.65]

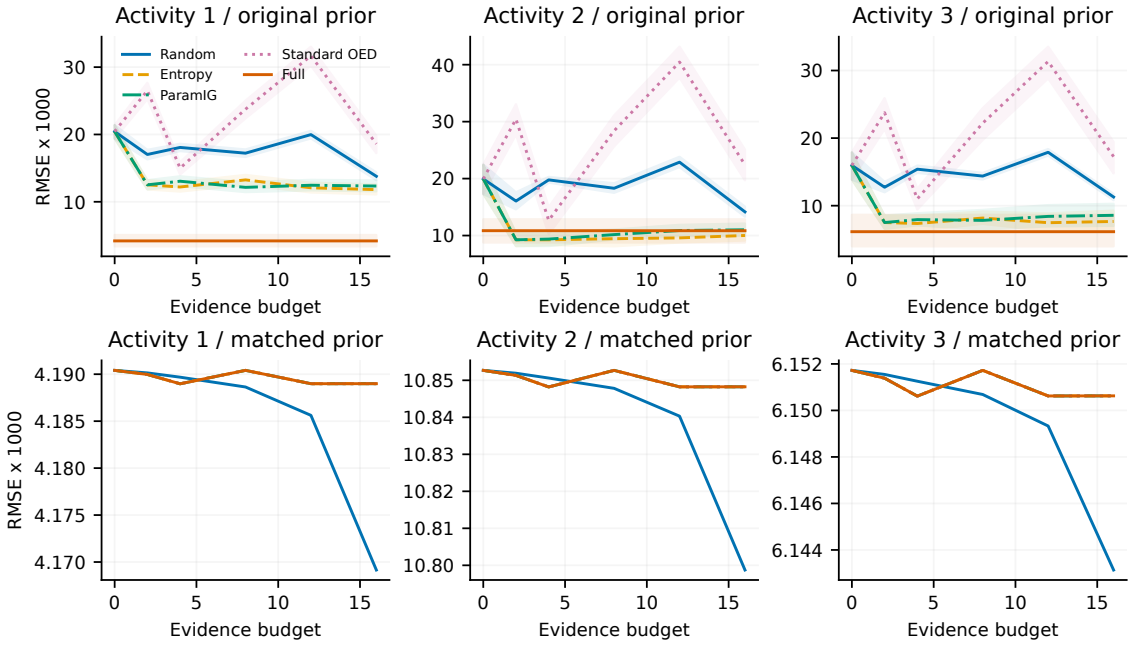


Figure 2: Synthetic budget–trajectory error curves, reported separately by activity. Top: original calibration policies with conditional 95% world-bootstrap shading. Bottom: all selectors share the evolved prior; curves nearly coincide. Bottom-row axes retain absolute values but use different scales, so their tiny variations should not be compared visually with top-row effect sizes.

Table 5: Ten synchronized, alternating-order GPU timing pairs. Median ratios are computed per pair; they need not equal the ratio of marginal medians.

Prior	Cov. (ms)	Enum. (ms)	Median ratio	Max. difference
frozen	0.773	178.17	217.95	9.08e-16
uniform compatible	0.747	191.85	275.16	1.38e-10

Table 6: Frozen-method ablations. Asterisks identify changes that also alter the prior or point-selection objective. Activity AUC $\times 10^3$ with 95% world-bootstrap intervals; 24 worlds, fixed training data, evidence and templates.

Method	Activity 1	Activity 2	Activity 3
Full	4.19 [3.38, 5.07]	10.85 [8.78, 12.85]	6.15 [3.98, 8.65]
Without sharing*	47.19 [45.23, 49.01]	21.17 [18.72, 23.61]	51.11 [48.60, 53.35]
Without combination target	4.19 [3.38, 5.07]	10.85 [8.78, 12.85]	6.15 [3.98, 8.65]
Original single point*	5.42 [4.71, 6.08]	7.54 [5.92, 9.35]	7.37 [5.78, 8.95]
Matched MAP	4.19 [3.38, 5.07]	10.85 [8.78, 12.85]	6.15 [3.99, 8.65]
Without batch conditioning	4.19 [3.38, 5.07]	10.85 [8.78, 12.85]	6.15 [3.98, 8.65]

217.95× under frozen weights and 275.16× under uniform compatible weights, with maximum score residuals. Figure 3 displays the raw timings. The reference is the supplied loop-based enumeration implementation; a fully vectorized enumerator can share much of the same work. Accordingly, these measurements establish a local implementation advantage, not a universal speedup over optimized OED or an asymptotic improvement. The canonical full frozen evaluation takes 7.69 seconds and reports 14.59 MB of peak allocated PyTorch GPU memory on an RTX 4060 Laptop GPU. These figures concern cached evaluation, excluding offline cache generation and graphics-driver memory. The development trials range from roughly four to nine seconds. Small cached evaluations are feasible on 8 GB VRAM, but this does not demonstrate equivalent scaling for larger populations or richer mechanism banks.

4.4 RQ3: Which changes survive controlled ablation?

Table 6 compares the full model with four requested removals and a matched point estimate. Removing the combination target or batch conditioning leaves the aggregate results unchanged. This is consistent with near-single-mechanism weights: altering which evidence is chosen has little effect if the likelihood cannot move substantial mass. Removing sharing worsens results, but its bank uses independent per-event parameter permutations and changes the prior and hypothesis space. The comparison is informative about that implementation, not a pure causal estimate of the benefit of sharing.

The development history explains the concentration. Rounds 1–7 introduce trajectory weighting and progressively narrow its kernel. Round 30 replaces average historical error with worst-event error. Round 38 narrows the kernel again, but the accepted improvement is only around 10^{-7} and should not be presented as a performance leap. Round 58 introduces the noise normalization in Eq. (5); it produces the largest later improvement. These sequential decisions are not independent ablations, since each accepted change becomes the next parent. All 60 scores and decisions appear in Appendix C.

The aggregate objective also trades off against process prediction: development Brier worsens from 0.189335 to 0.242053, and frozen-test Brier is 0.245921. Frozen-test pointwise coverage is 97.92% with mean width 0.030382. High marginal coverage does not establish identified mechanisms or calibrated out-of-model uncertainty. The independent-world uncertainty table (Table 13) separates epistemic and aleatoric contributions; the former is tiny relative to the latter under the selected weights.

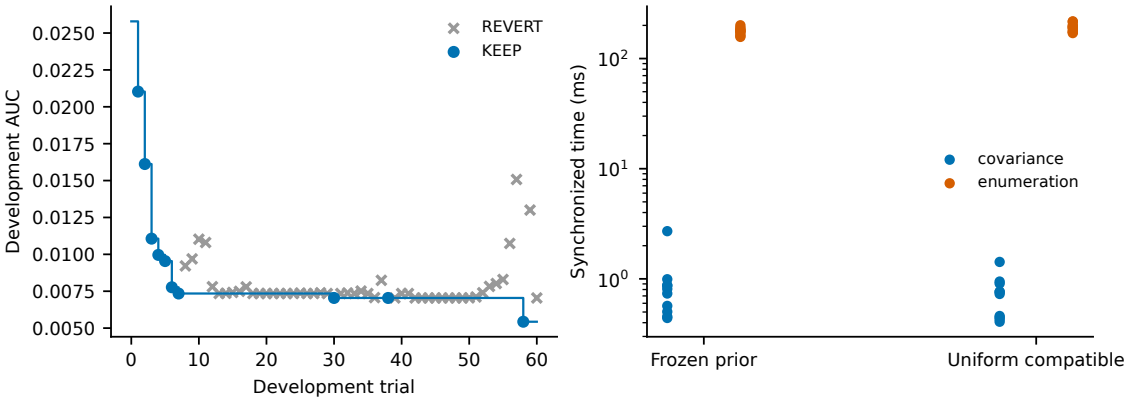


Figure 3: Left: all 60 development candidates and the retained-score trajectory. Reverted trials remain visible. Right: all ten timing pairs for each prior; the logarithmic axis distinguishes covariance and explicit enumeration costs without treating timing repetitions as independent activity replicates.

4.5 Round 2: noncollapsed calibration and matched-prior acquisition

A prospective extension, with V1 retained. Sections 3 and 4.1–4.4 describe the original V1 study. We now test the specific failure identified there: can evidence acquisition become useful when calibration retains plausible alternatives? We preserve V1 commit `eb641c2` and its original data, then preregister a separate stress configuration, three statistical guards, and 30 development configurations. Both versions are evaluated on this new configuration; its scores must not be compared numerically with the earlier benchmark's scores as if only the algorithm had changed.

Controlled ambiguity and inferential units. The new simulator uses 256 agents, eight rollout seeds, 12 time steps, and 200 candidate mechanisms. The fixed pair $(a, b, d) = (.2, .95, .12)$ and $(.95, .2, .12)$ has the same attention–participation product. Inverse-transform common random numbers generate the same initial intentions for this pair. History activates queueing or forwarding separately; queue-enabled peer notices in the combination activate an eight-neighbor cascade, together with strong same-time conflict blocking. The pair's historical RMSE is 0.00000, whereas its probe and test-design disagreement is 0.28094. This is a deliberately constructed interaction, not a fitted human behavioral law. Development uses 12 independently simulated worlds and test uses 24 fresh worlds. Test reuses the fixed combined event design; it is fresh-world replication, not an additional unseen combination beyond the probe design. All confidence intervals resample complete worlds and preserve within-world activity dependence.

Calibration and acceptance rule. For the V1-compatible support $\mathcal{C}$, let r_{etc} denote the relative seed-variance normalization from Eq. (5). V2 uses

$$E_m^{(2)} = \frac{1}{2\sigma^2}\,\mathrm{mean}_{e,t,c}\,\frac{(\bar{X}_{metc} - H_{etc})^2}{r_{etc}} + \lambda \ell_m^{\mathrm{proc}}, \tag{17}$$

$$\ell_m^{\mathrm{proc}} = -\frac{1}{|\mathcal{O}|}\sum_{j\in\mathcal{O}}[y_j \log p_{mj} + (1-y_j)\log(1-p_{mj})], \tag{18}$$

$$w_{0m}^{(2)} \propto \mathbf{1}[m \in \mathcal{C}]\exp(-E_m^{(2)}/T), \qquad T = \inf\{t \geq 1 :\ N_{\mathrm{eff}}(w_0(t)) \geq 8\}. \tag{19}$$

The implementation uses a small numerical margin and bisection for the temperature floor; MCAR missing history labels contribute no log likelihood. Unobserved views in intention records remain marginalized through $p_{mj} = a_m b_m I_j$. The support filter is unchanged. The mean residual above describes the selected V2 configuration; worst-event variants are also included in the search. Gibbs

Table 7: V1 and V2 on the same Round-2 stress benchmark. Brier is measured on the independent process audit at budget 16.

Version	Split	ESS	AUC	B0 error	B16 error	Brier
V1	Dev	1.01	0.14410	0.14606	0.14003	0.18197
V2	Dev	26.45	0.07569	0.13327	0.04750	0.17416
V1	Test	1.01	0.14389	0.14601	0.14007	0.18223
V2	Test	26.45	0.05776	0.13319	0.03948	0.17438

Table 8: Frozen-test selectors, matched within each version on prior and update. Intervals resample 24 whole worlds.

Version	Selector	AUC	95% interval	Brier
V1	Full	0.14389	[0.14281, 0.14474]	0.18223
V1	Random	0.14589	[0.14561, 0.14618]	0.18291
V1	Entropy	0.14601	[0.14572, 0.14631]	0.18296
V1	ParamIG	0.14389	[0.14281, 0.14474]	0.18223
V1	Standard_OED	0.14392	[0.14284, 0.14477]	0.18223
V2	Full	0.05776	[0.04948, 0.06688]	0.17438
V2	Random	0.11579	[0.10012, 0.13205]	0.18523
V2	Entropy	0.13319	[0.13294, 0.13346]	0.18800
V2	ParamIG	0.05776	[0.04948, 0.06688]	0.17438
V2	Standard_OED	0.13315	[0.13253, 0.13372]	0.18810

temperature has an entropy-regularization interpretation, but the enforced effective size is based on Rényi-2 entropy, not Shannon entropy.

A candidate is retained only if development AUC improves by more than 10^{-8} and all guards hold: initial effective size at least eight; both initial and budget-16 audit Brier at most .195; a strictly positive lower endpoint of the paired 95% bootstrap interval for $R(0) - R(16)$; at least 5% lower AUC than both matched-prior Random and Entropy; and fast-development runtime at most 15 seconds. All selectors within a version share initial weights, observations, costs, missingness, and posterior update. With selected evidence D, the update is

$$w_m(D) \propto w_{0m} \exp\left\{ \tau^{-1} \sum_{j \in D \cap \mathcal{O}} \log p_m(y_j) \right\}. \tag{20}$$

The winner uses $\sigma = 0.008$, $\lambda = 8$ and $\tau = 0.5$, with unweighted probe times and two-query fantasy conditioning. Both hypothetical branches use the same likelihood temperature as the real update. For $\tau \neq 1$, this is a generalized-Bayes update: the original covariance score is still used as a heuristic acquisition ranking, and is not claimed to equal the exact variance reduction of the tempered posterior. No submodularity guarantee is added.

Frozen results. Thirty valid trials yield 3 KEEP and 27 REVERT decisions with no runtime failures. The selected commit is `0d094ec`. Initial effective size is 26.45, compared with 1.01 for V1 on this new cache. Table 7 reports the matched benchmark comparison. V2 development AUC is 0.07569, with gains of 27.5% and 43.2% over matched-prior Random and Entropy. The algorithm is sealed before test truth is loaded. Test Full AUC is 0.05776 (95% interval [0.04948, 0.06688]), compared with 0.14389 for V1: a 59.9% reduction on the same new benchmark. V2 test error falls from 0.13319 at zero evidence to 0.03948 at budget 16; the paired improvement interval is [0.08321, 0.10258]. Initial and final test Brier are 0.18800 and 0.17438, respectively. Initial Brier is worse than V1's even though both satisfy the guard; the improvement occurs after evidence acquisition.

On test, Full improves AUC by 50.1% over same-prior Random and 56.6% over same-prior Entropy. The paired intervals for baseline-minus-Full AUC are [0.03946, 0.07722] and [0.06633,

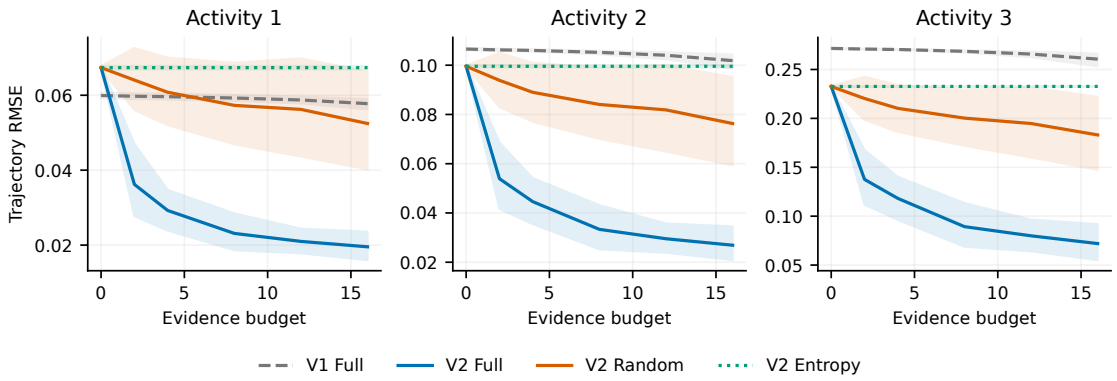


Figure 4: Round-2 frozen-test curves, separately by activity. Shading is a pointwise 95% whole-world bootstrap interval. V2 selectors share their prior and update; V1 uses its own original calibration. ParamIG coincides with V2 Full and is omitted for legibility.

Table 9: Frozen-test activity results. Each template has 24 independent world realizations; activities within a world are not independent.

Version	Activity	AUC	AUC 95% interval	B0–B16 95% interval
V1	1	0.05911	[0.05831, 0.05992]	[0.00109, 0.00358]
V1	2	0.10486	[0.10382, 0.10567]	[0.00228, 0.00785]
V1	3	0.26770	[0.26578, 0.26916]	[0.00519, 0.01849]
V2	1	0.02769	[0.02393, 0.03177]	[0.04375, 0.05123]
V2	2	0.04041	[0.03429, 0.04726]	[0.06506, 0.07858]
V2	3	0.10519	[0.09004, 0.12190]	[0.14057, 0.17774]

0.08376]. Figure 4 shows that the reduction is present for each activity, with activitywise uncertainty in Table 9. However, ParamIG selects the same records and exactly matches Full, so this experiment does not establish superiority of prediction-oriented covariance scoring over parameter information gain. The standard OED control targets historical trajectories and is weaker here; it is not an optimized compositional OED oracle.

What changed, and what remains unproved. The thirty configurations produce 18 distinct development AUC values. Raising the effective-size floor from 8 to 24 at the winner's calibration width has no effect because its unconstrained effective size already exceeds 24. Thus the guard prevents inadmissible winners, but its active intervention is not the cause of the selected configuration's gain. With width .008 and process weight 8 fixed, changing τ from 1 to .5 reduces AUC from 0.08193 to 0.07569; $\tau = 2$ worsens it to 0.09056. These are controlled temperature comparisons. Comparisons across other groups also change width, process weight or loss aggregation and cannot identify their individual causal contributions. Removing fantasy conditioning produces the same selected records and score in the matched configurations; this pool supplies no evidence for a separate batch-conditioning benefit.

The acquisition pool deliberately contains 24 view records, 40 known-probability availability records with $p = .5$, and 96 marginalized intention records. Maximum entropy spends its budget on irreducible availability uncertainty, while the informative view records distinguish the ambiguous attention mechanisms. This design makes the failure mode interpretable but limits generality: it favors information-sensitive selection over a pure predictive-entropy heuristic, and does not establish robust dominance on arbitrary pools. The wider test improvement than development is conditional on the fixed historical cohort and different acquisition answers; the 12-world development set is small. This constructed setting restores acquisition value; it does not establish real-world identification, new risk guarantees, or official rankings.

5 Discussion and related work

5.1 Relationship to calibration and experimental design

Calibration under non-identifiability. Bayesian computer-model calibration distinguishes parameter uncertainty from model discrepancy (Kennedy and O'Hagan, 2001). Eligibility-set calibration already addresses non-identifiability in multi-agent simulators and combines distributional comparison with Bayesian optimization (Bai et al., 2022). Our empirical process/trajectory gates are simpler and lack their statistical test interpretation. Bayesian optimization for likelihood-free inference allocates expensive simulator evaluations (Gutmann and Corander, 2016); our acquisition instead allocates access to process records after rollouts have been cached. These are different resource decisions. Set calibration itself is therefore not a novelty claim. The contribution lies in its explicit coupling to stage-level evidence opportunities, composed target trajectories, and an auditable evaluation of when that coupling becomes ineffective.

Prediction-directed acquisition. Variance-based active learning has a long history (Cohn et al., 1996), and Bayesian design provides a decision-theoretic framework for utility-dependent data acquisition (Chaloner and Verdinelli, 1995). Goal-oriented OED targets predictive quantities rather than all parameter uncertainty (Attia et al., 2018; Zhong et al., 2026). Our squared-covariance score is a finite binary-observation specialization of that perspective, using a variance utility rather than predictive information gain. A record with high entropy can still have zero value if every mechanism assigns it the same probability or if it is uncorrelated with the probe prediction. The relevant practical decisions are the validity of stage likelihoods, the target probe distribution, numerical support preservation, and computation reuse. The current evidence supports the last of these most clearly.

Social simulation systems. CALM combines calibrated stochastic choice with activity-based traveler simulation (Cheng, 2026); it concerns a specific empirical mobility setting rather than the finite process-record acquisition problem studied here. SocioVerse2 develops longitudinal simulation and research loops for social systems (Zhang et al., 2026). Large Population Models emphasize population-scale behavior and interactions (Chopra, 2025). These systems motivate reusable interfaces between mechanisms, observations, and collective outcomes. They are not empirical baselines in this paper, and an adapter bearing a benchmark name is not a reproduction of their evaluation. The proposal's broader aim of recovering individual dynamics from macro observations is also reflected in macro2mind (Zhao et al., 2026); we do not implement or compare that model. Real-domain comparisons would require compatible observation opportunities, licensed data, and a named, frozen scoring protocol.

5.2 Scope, boundary conditions, and failure modes

Concentration removes the signal used by acquisition. As w approaches a point mass, $\mathrm{Cov}_w(p_r, Z) \to 0$ for every record and hence $A_r(w) \to 0$. A large hard-compatible set is therefore not sufficient to preserve epistemic uncertainty. The chosen small kernel width and finite-precision softmax jointly restrict effective support. Posterior updates cannot recover candidates with exactly zero mass. The observed absence of acquisition gains is consistent with this limit, but proving its quantitative contribution would require controlled interventions beyond this frozen study.

Why plausible development changes failed. Wider kernels in rounds 8–9 and 36–37 were reverted: keeping more candidate mass increased prediction error on the chosen development objective. Mixing in uniform weight in rounds 14–17 and 50–53 also failed to improve it. These outcomes distinguish numerical diversity from accurate uncertainty; they do not prove that diverse sets are generally inferior. Stronger evidence likelihoods at temperatures 0.05 and 0.1 worsened results in rounds 10–11, consistent with noisy binary evidence exerting excessive influence under a

mismatched finite bank. Later temperature changes had only negligible effects once the mixture was already concentrated.

Rounds 18–23 added process Brier energy with almost no change in the retained behavior. Rounds 24–29 changed channel weights without exceeding the acceptance threshold. Alternative worst-channel, absolute, Huber, trimmed, and late-time objectives in rounds 31–35 did not improve the score. These losses encode different notions of fit; none is a universally valid robustness correction. Probe-coordinate rescaling in rounds 42–45 produced identical AUC, an especially direct warning against describing those rejected ideas as innovations in the final method. Seed-marginalized kernels in rounds 54–57 performed worse, but this changed both the calibration construction and kernel scale, so the result does not show that modeling randomness is harmful. Finally, raising the variance floor in rounds 59–60 reversed the benefit of round 58. Sensitivity to this regularizer is a limitation, not evidence that the selected value transfers to new domains.

Batch conditioning does not imply submodularity. Adaptive-submodularity guarantees require a diminishing-returns property (Golovin and Krause, 2011). Our objective does not satisfy it in general. Consider a mechanism indexed by two independent fair bits (U, V), target $Z = U \oplus V$, and two noiseless queries revealing U and V. Either query alone leaves target variance unchanged, while both determine Z. The marginal value of the second query increases after acquiring the first, violating diminishing returns, even though query outcomes are deterministic and thus conditionally independent given the mechanism. This analytical counterexample explains why exact fantasy averaging is described as greedy conditional acquisition, without a generic approximation guarantee.

Agreement can coexist with arbitrary misspecification. Suppose all candidates predict z_0 while an omitted environmental rule makes reality $z_0 + \Delta$. Every epistemic covariance and acquisition score is zero, while mean squared error is $\|\Delta\|^2/D$. The variance-reduction identity remains valid internally. It cannot discover a mechanism absent from the candidate class, and broad aleatoric intervals may conceal weak shifts. Post-observation residual checks provide a different source of evidence, but the tested thresholds have neither calibrated false-positive control nor advance-warning guarantees. Candidate expansion and explicit discrepancy models are possible remedies, not implemented successes.

What the current evidence does and does not support. The same development split selected 60 candidates; reporting its best score without the full search history would overstate validation. The test evaluation and independent-world extension strengthen reproducibility but retain fixed templates, training data, evidence, and a small finite mechanism bank. No confidence interval here covers uncertainty over human populations or over the search procedure itself. The Round-2 extension in Section 4.5 partially addresses this issue with fresh acquisition cohorts and a new sealed holdout. Further evaluation should vary event designs, historical datasets and query pools, include same-prior optimized OED, and test whether the noncollapsed acquisition benefit persists outside the constructed stress setting. It would also isolate sharing from prior changes and validate observation models before using real behavioral records.

5.3 Conclusion

The study makes a budgeted process-evidence loop explicit and inexpensive to execute, with complete-path prediction and separable uncertainty terms. Its strongest empirical lesson is that successful aggregate calibration can eliminate the mechanism disagreement on which active evidence selection depends. The frozen implementation improves synthetic trajectory prediction and accelerates a reference scoring calculation, but the V1 matched controls do not establish an acquisition or set-retention advantage. The separate V2 stress test restores an acquisition advantage over matched Random and Entropy while tying ParamIG; its constructed nuisance pool and inactive batch ablation limit the claim. Treating that distinction as a result yields a more useful foundation

for compositional social simulation than an unsupported claim of mechanism identification or external benchmark superiority.

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A Additional results and audit trail

All tables below are generated from the same sealed result files as the main text. They are not additional tuning runs. Table 10 retains the original evaluator's pooled metric, whereas the other activity tables use independent-world replication. The distinction prevents a change in aggregation from being mistaken for a change in performance.

Table 10: Original frozen test cache, descriptive results. Random is averaged over its three query repetitions. These interacting activities do not constitute independent replicates.

Method	Pooled AUC	Brier	NLL	Coverage	Width
Random	0.017980	0.1957	0.5775	1.0000	0.0666
Entropy	0.011052	0.1862	0.5572	1.0000	0.0691
ParamIG	0.011017	0.1860	0.5618	1.0000	0.0679
Standard OED	0.025494	0.2086	0.6021	1.0000	0.0666
Full	0.006916	0.2459	0.6811	0.9792	0.0304
Simple statistics	0.023584	0.3026	0.8458	0.8125	0.0318
Uncalibrated	0.017490	0.2144	0.6139	1.0000	0.0896
Process only	0.019877	0.2238	0.6328	1.0000	0.0769
Trajectory only	0.018181	0.2202	0.6253	1.0000	0.0804
Passive V1	0.019877	0.2238	0.6328	1.0000	0.0769
Without sharing*	0.051271	0.2050	0.6108	0.6146	0.0360
Without combination target	0.006916	0.2459	0.6811	0.9792	0.0304
Original single point*	0.008321	0.2513	0.7070	0.9479	0.0291

Table 11: Passive calibration baselines. These rows acquire no additional evidence. Activity AUC $\times 10^3$ with 95% world-bootstrap intervals; 24 worlds, fixed training data, evidence and templates.

Method	Activity 1	Activity 2	Activity 3
Simple statistics	24.05 [23.81, 24.30]	32.30 [30.39, 34.18]	18.84 [18.07, 19.77]
Uncalibrated	19.99 [19.34, 20.63]	17.08 [15.25, 18.87]	13.81 [12.79, 14.89]
Process only	20.43 [19.38, 21.40]	19.94 [17.30, 22.45]	15.96 [13.85, 17.89]
Trajectory only	19.56 [18.65, 20.40]	17.66 [15.15, 20.03]	14.28 [12.53, 15.93]
Passive V1	20.43 [19.38, 21.40]	19.94 [17.30, 22.45]	15.96 [13.85, 17.89]

Table 12: Paired activity AUC differences $\times 10^6$ with 95% world-bootstrap intervals. Positive favors Full; tiny differences are not necessarily practically meaningful.

Comparator minus Full	Activity 1	Activity 2	Activity 3
Matched MAP	1.19 [0.62, 1.84]	3.72 [2.22, 5.21]	0.92 [-0.18, 2.07]
Matched-prior Random	-3.61 [-5.60, -1.70]	-8.86 [-13.65, -3.83]	-1.38 [-5.02, 2.14]
Without combination target	0.00 [0.00, 0.00]	0.00 [0.00, 0.00]	0.00 [0.00, 0.00]
Without batch conditioning	0.00 [0.00, 0.00]	0.00 [0.00, 0.00]	0.00 [0.00, 0.00]

Table 13: Final-budget uncertainty: means and 95% world-bootstrap intervals. Coverage concerns pointwise 90% predictive intervals.

Quantity	Activity 1	Activity 2	Activity 3
Coverage (percent)	94.0 [91.9, 95.9]	90.8 [87.9, 93.7]	92.5 [89.0, 95.4]
Interval width (fraction)	0.0167 [0.0135, 0.0202]	0.0349 [0.0313, 0.0387]	0.0304 [0.0277, 0.0333]
Epistemic variance x 1e8	3.41 [2.65, 4.22]	9.71 [6.72, 13.12]	4.45 [3.01, 6.14]
Aleatoric variance x 1e4	0.91 [0.69, 1.14]	3.04 [2.48, 3.69]	2.42 [2.05, 2.80]

Table 14: True trajectory displacement relative to the no-shift world, RMSE $\times 10^3$. Reported separately to distinguish weak perturbations from insensitive detection.

Truth rule	Activity 1	Activity 2	Activity 3
none	0.00 [0.00, 0.00]	0.00 [0.00, 0.00]	0.00 [0.00, 0.00]
waiting	3.55 [3.18, 3.93]	0.61 [0.28, 0.97]	0.38 [0.18, 0.61]
propagation	7.92 [7.35, 8.54]	10.16 [9.17, 11.16]	19.64 [18.42, 20.70]
both	7.37 [6.75, 8.07]	10.15 [9.17, 11.15]	19.21 [17.98, 20.30]
transport	59.52 [58.46, 60.48]	74.78 [72.55, 76.86]	53.31 [51.58, 54.89]

B Reproduction and evidence provenance

The frozen V1 algorithm is commit `eb641c2`; its SHA-256 is recorded in the machine-readable artifact manifest. The manuscript generator verifies this hash before producing figures. It reads the canonical frozen evaluation, the fixed 24-world supplement, the audited candidate ledger, and the campaign summary. All other root-level JSON results are inventoried with hashes and retained as historical or reproduction runs, rather than selected by test performance. The candidate audit reconciles decision rows with evaluation rows by run identifier and verifies their Git sources. Thus 60 candidates, not the number of ledger lines, define the search budget.

The release separates environment preparation, the fixed evaluator, the sole evolvable algorithm file, and the search controller. Sections 1–4.4 retain those V1 components; Section 4.5 reports a separately frozen V2 campaign. The original cache contains labels in the same local process; source checks and API conventions provide auditability, not an adversarially secure holdout. A deployment with sensitive observations would require a separate permission-controlled evaluation service.

These commands apply only to the archived V1 environment.

To rebuild its figures and PDF, run `python paper/generate_artifacts.py`, followed by `python paper/build.py`, from the repository root in the supplied research environment. The latter invokes pdfLaTeX and BibTeX from the paper directory and checks the final log for unresolved references and layout warnings. The standalone paper source directory also supports conventional pdfLaTeX–BibTeX compilation. The research reproduction script at the root is separate: it can rerun the sealed synthetic experiments but is not required to typeset the manuscript. Cached evaluation excludes offline simulation cost; Table 5 additionally excludes cache loading, calibration, posterior prediction, and figure generation.

No human participants were recruited and no real student records were used. The executable social model represents a constructed resource-participation process. Its parameters must not be interpreted as estimates of individual psychological traits. The SocioVerse and SocialSim integration materials are interface preparation, not evidence of external validity or an official leaderboard submission.

The current branch uses `paper/update_round2.py` to regenerate the extension from canonical sealed results, then `paper/build.py` and `paper/build_zh.py` to compile. The original V1 release archive remains available; its old infrastructure lock must not be used against the V2 files.

C Complete development decisions

Table 15 reports every accepted and rejected candidate in chronological order. Rejection includes changes that were numerically indistinguishable or smaller than the predeclared acceptance threshold; it does not always mean a substantial deterioration. Hypotheses, full source hashes, and exact candidate files remain in the repository's evolution audit. These observations explain the selected implementation but do not replace a new independent comparison of the corresponding mathematical choices.

Table 15: All 60 audited candidates. Development scores are adaptively selected, not independent validation.

Round	Dev AUC	Parent AUC	Decision	Commit
1	0.02103133	0.02579135	KEEP	9004e27
2	0.01612103	0.02103133	KEEP	6bb9ddb
3	0.01106276	0.01612103	KEEP	73386c1
4	0.00996100	0.01106276	KEEP	728d215
5	0.00954380	0.00996100	KEEP	ba8b306
6	0.00776780	0.00954380	KEEP	d5e58c8
7	0.00734499	0.00776780	KEEP	ef86a46
8	0.00921580	0.00734499	REVERT	73f16c4
9	0.00969213	0.00734499	REVERT	478719a
10	0.01102639	0.00734499	REVERT	05f5dcf
11	0.01080275	0.00734499	REVERT	b4c4fca
12	0.00780723	0.00734499	REVERT	3088266
13	0.00734522	0.00734499	REVERT	b4fe2a0
14	0.00735953	0.00734499	REVERT	3df239c
15	0.00741803	0.00734499	REVERT	25afcf5
16	0.00749185	0.00734499	REVERT	4b1e757
17	0.00779464	0.00734499	REVERT	bff1fc7
18	0.00734499	0.00734499	REVERT	ff4fbbf
19	0.00734499	0.00734499	REVERT	dbba10b
20	0.00734499	0.00734499	REVERT	e09f641
21	0.00734499	0.00734499	REVERT	35d2997
22	0.00734499	0.00734499	REVERT	99e2128
23	0.00734499	0.00734499	REVERT	0a72bd0
24	0.00734499	0.00734499	REVERT	2721c24
25	0.00737358	0.00734499	REVERT	6ebab02
26	0.00734499	0.00734499	REVERT	0cae7ed
27	0.00734532	0.00734499	REVERT	7292291
28	0.00739139	0.00734499	REVERT	037df88
29	0.00734499	0.00734499	REVERT	d83f2e1
30	0.00704311	0.00734499	KEEP	98d6fb0
31	0.00734499	0.00704311	REVERT	bc4d425
32	0.00738014	0.00704311	REVERT	55a1b8f
33	0.00734523	0.00704311	REVERT	f29e090
34	0.00751265	0.00704311	REVERT	07fe993
35	0.00734499	0.00704311	REVERT	4e8b0ca
36	0.00706689	0.00704311	REVERT	f929916
37	0.00823951	0.00704311	REVERT	f7fee7e
38	0.00704303	0.00704311	KEEP	6a44dfc
39	0.00704303	0.00704303	REVERT	9007fd6
40	0.00734499	0.00704303	REVERT	4612d6b
41	0.00734499	0.00704303	REVERT	7702d9c
42	0.00704303	0.00704303	REVERT	6ff50b7
43	0.00704303	0.00704303	REVERT	eb9bd17
44	0.00704303	0.00704303	REVERT	8361b7a
45	0.00704303	0.00704303	REVERT	be36314
46	0.00704304	0.00704303	REVERT	871658d
47	0.00704303	0.00704303	REVERT	f7077c6
48	0.00704303	0.00704303	REVERT	320da5d
49	0.00704303	0.00704303	REVERT	945ecb9
50	0.00704964	0.00704303	REVERT	34ebfd4
51	0.00711002	0.00704303	REVERT	72363f1
52	0.00739650	0.00704303	REVERT	39cf814
53	0.00782675	0.00704303	REVERT	307cd3d
54	0.00802215	0.00704303	REVERT	c34f927
55	0.00829448	0.00704303	REVERT	a7e246c
56	0.01073823	0.00704303	REVERT	3c56dc0
57	0.01507502	0.00704303	REVERT	b4ee347
58	0.00543199	0.00704303	KEEP	eb641c2
59	0.01300248	0.00543199	REVERT	1b4c940
60	0.00704303	0.00543199	REVERT	135f671